

» OPOSSUMS



11–14.5 cm
4¼–5¾ in

LINNAEUS'S MOUSE OPOSSUM
Murinus murina

Widespread in forests, pampas, and plantations in S. America, this agile, nocturnal climber has a long, prehensile tail.



12–22 cm
4¾–9 in

WOOLLY MOUSE OPOSSUM
Marmosa sp.

Living in C. and S. America, this pouchless marsupial with thick, woolly fur is arboreal, nocturnal, and omnivorous.



26–40 cm
10–16 in

WATER OPOSSUM
Chironectes minimus

The only aquatic marsupial, this opossum of C. and S. America is also unique in that both sexes have a pouch, but it is only watertight in females.



9–14 cm
3½–5½ in

ELEGANT FAT-TAILED MOUSE OPOSSUM
Thylamys elegans

Like several other opossums, this marsupial from Chile stores fat in its tail as winter approaches.



12–14.5 cm
4¾–5¾ in

PATAGONIAN OPOSSUM
Lestodelphys halli

Living in shrub, savanna, and grassland in Argentina, the Patagonian opossum has the most southerly distribution of any opossum species.



20–33 cm
8–13 in

GREY FOUR-EYED OPOSSUM
Philander opossum

This opossum has white spots on its forehead, making it look as if it has four eyes. It lives in Mexico, and C. and S. America.



12–18 cm
4¾–7 in

GREY SHORT-TAILED OPOSSUM
Monodelphis domestica

Found in Argentina, Brazil, Bolivia, and Paraguay, this short-tailed opossum sometimes inhabits human dwellings, as well as forest, scrub, and grassland.

NUMBAT

The numbat is the only member of the family Myrmecobiidae. It has a distinctive striped coat, strong claws for digging, and a very long tongue for extracting termites from their nests.

NUMBAT
Myrmecobius fasciatus
Found only in eucalyptus forest and woodland in Western Australia, this diurnal marsupial is a specialized termite-eater.



22–29 cm
9–11½ in

BILBIES

The family Thylacomyidae has only one species, since the lesser bilby has been declared extinct. Living in arid habitats, this nocturnal marsupial does not need to drink water, as it absorbs moisture from its food.

GREATER BILBY
Macrotis lagotis
A burrowing species of the desert of C. Australia, this marsupial has silky fur, a tricoloured tail, and long, rabbit-like ears.



30–55 cm
12–22 in